

All You Want to Know About NAS!

In this article we go through the basics of network attached storage (NAS), a dedicated hard disk device that provides file-based data storage services to other devices on the network.



NAS is a file-based network file sharing system. It enables the sharing of data storage over the network across a heterogeneous client group using the client-server architecture. A NAS system consists of a single hardware device, generally called the NAS server or NAS head, which acts as an interface between the NAS and all the network clients. All the clients in the NAS system generally access the storage over Ethernet.

FreeNAS is a free, common and easy-to-use platform. It is a free and open source solution that is optimised for creating NAS infrastructure with vendor-independent and easy-to-use management software.

Let's bring FreeNAS to reality

Now that we know about FreeNAS, let's see how easy it is to create FreeNAS infrastructure.

Technically, users can create Network Attached Storage

(NAS) on any hardware platform. It is an embedded system based on FreeBSD. The FreeNAS Project was founded in 2005 on the principle that network storage ought to be made available to the world at no cost and uncumbered by licence restrictions. The FreeNAS Project has a mature community and a team of developers dedicated to reaching that goal and providing the best open source NAS solution in the market.

System requirements

To create industry standard FreeNAS infrastructure there are specific hardware requirements and guidelines that ensure performance improvements. But, at the same time, since it is as simple as playing a game, it's worth giving it a try even for personal use or home requirements.

Let's bring up a VM for our use with the FreeNAS operating system for simple data sharing, so that we do not have to bother too much about performance.